“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 5

The Story of Pradyumna Miśra

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

1 Bitten by the worm of ripened karma, tormented by the sore of malice, and sunk in an ocean of humility, I take shelter of Caitanya, the physician.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, the son of Śacī! Glory, glory to the all-merciful, blessed Nityānanda!

3 Glory to Advaita, the ocean of mercy! Glory to all the devotees! Glory to Svarūpa, Gadādhara, Rūpa and Sanātana!

4 One day Pradyumna Miśra bowed down at the Lord’s feet and humbly made a request.

5 “Hear me, O Lord: I am a wretched, lowly householder. By what fortune have I obtained Your feet, so rarely attained?

6 I wish to hear talks about Kṛṣṇa. Be kind to me and tell me about Kṛṣṇa.”

7 The Lord said, “I know nothing of talks about Kṛṣṇa. Only Rāmānanda knows them, and I hear them from his lips.[2]

8 It is your good fortune that your mind longs to hear about Kṛṣṇa. Go to Rāmānanda and hear from him.

9 You have a taste for talks about Kṛṣṇa — you are greatly fortunate! Whoever has such a taste is truly fortunate."

10 "Dharma, however well a person performs it, is nothing but wasted labour if it does not awaken attraction (*rati*) to the narrations about the Lord, Viṣvaksena." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.2.8)[3]

11 Then Pradyumna Miśra went to Rāmānanda's house, and Rāya's servant offered him a seat.

12 Not seeing Rāya, he asked the servant, who told him what Rāya was doing:

13 "There are two maidens of the Deity (*deva-kanyās*), supremely beautiful, very skilled in dance and song, and in the bloom of youth.[4]

14 Rāya has taken them both to a secluded garden and is teaching them to dance to the songs of his own drama.[5]

15 Please sit here and wait; he will come shortly. Whatever you ask of him, he will do."

16 So Pradyumna Miśra stayed there, waiting, while Rāmānanda, in a secluded place, attended to the two maidens.

17 With his own hands he anointed them with oil; with his own hands he bathed them and cleansed their bodies.

18 With his own hands he dressed them and adorned every limb, and yet the mind of Rāya Rāmānanda remained unmoved.

19 What one feels on touching wood or stone, Rāmānanda by nature feels on touching a young woman.

20 Seeing in them the ones to be served (*sevya-buddhi*), he served them, assuming, as was natural to him, the mood of a maidservant.[6]

21 The glory of Mahāprabhu's devotees is unfathomable, and in Rāmānanda *bhāva*, bhakti and prema reach their utmost limit.

22 Then he taught the two to dance and had them act out the hidden meaning of the songs.[7]

23 By acting with face and eyes, they brought out the signs of the transitory (*sañcārī*), the sāttvika and the abiding (*sthāyi*) feelings.

24 Rāya taught them the graceful feminine dance (*lāsya*) that reveals *bhāva*, and the two would display it openly before Jagannātha.

25 Then he gave the two prasāda to eat and quietly sent them home.[8]

26 Every day Rāya trained them in this way. What petty soul can know where his mind dwells?

27 The servant told Rāya that Miśra had come, and Rāmānanda at once came to the hall.

28 Showing him respect, he bowed to Miśra and humbly said:

29 “You have been here a long while, and no one told me. I have committed an offence at your feet.

30 Your coming has purified my home. Command me — what shall I, your servant, do?”

31 Miśra said, “I came to see you, and by seeing you I have purified myself.”

32 Seeing that it was too late, Miśra said nothing more; he took his leave and went home.

33 The next day Miśra came before the Lord, and the Lord asked, “Did you hear about Kṛṣṇa from Rāya?”

34 Then Miśra told Him what Rāmānanda had been doing, and when Mahāprabhu heard it, He began to speak.

35–36 “I am a sannyāsī and consider Myself detached; yet, to say nothing of seeing a woman, if I merely hear a woman’s name, My body and mind are disturbed. Who can remain steady on seeing a woman?[9]

37 Hear, all of you, about Rāmānanda Rāya — an account so wondrous that it can hardly be told.

38 First, they are *devadāsīs*, maidservants of the Deity, and moreover they are beautiful young women; yet he himself performs every service for them.[10]

39 He bathes them and dresses them in clothes and ornaments, and he sees and touches all the hidden parts of their bodies.

40 Yet the mind of Rāya Rāmānanda remains unmoved as he teaches them to express the stirrings of many different *bhāvas*.[11]

41 His body and mind are unmoved, like wood or stone. How wonderful — at the touch of a young woman his mind is unmoved!

42 Rāmānanda alone has this qualification; from it I know that his body is transcendental.

43 Only he knows the state of his mind; there is no one else fit to know it.

44 But in the light of scripture I draw one inference. The *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* bears witness to this.[12]

45–46 When a person, with faith, hears and tells of Kṛṣṇa's rāsa dance and His other pastimes with the young women of Vraja, his lust, the disease of the heart, is destroyed at once. The three guṇas no longer agitate him, and he becomes perfectly steady (*mahā-dhīra*).[13]

47 He attains prema-bhakti in the radiant *madhura-rasa*, and in bliss he ever revels in Kṛṣṇa's sweetness.

48 "The steadfast soul who, endowed with faith, constantly hears of this play of Viṣṇu with the young women of Vraja and then describes it, soon attains supreme devotion to the Lord and quickly casts off lust, the disease of the heart." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.33.39)[14]

49 Such is the fruit for whoever hears or reads of these pastimes. But as for one who, absorbed in *bhāva*, serves day and night —[15]

50 what can I say of his fruit? It cannot be put into words. He is eternally perfect (*nitya-siddha*), and his body is almost perfect (*prāya-siddha*).[16]

51 I know that Rāya's worship follows the path of rāgānuga. His body is like a perfected spiritual body (*siddha-deha*), and so his mind is not mundane.

52 I too hear about Kṛṣṇa from Rāya. If you wish to hear, go there again.

53 Tell him in My name: 'He has sent me to hear about Kṛṣṇa from you.'

54 Go quickly, while he is still in the hall." Hearing this, Pradyumna Miśra set off in haste.

55 He went to Rāya, and Rāya bowed to him and said, "Command me; tell me why you have come."

56 Miśra said, "Mahāprabhu has sent me to hear about Kṛṣṇa from you."

57 Hearing this, Rāmānanda was pleased, and with joy in his heart he began to speak:

58 "By the Lord's order you have come here to hear about Kṛṣṇa. Where else could I find such great fortune?"

59 Saying this, he took him to a secluded place, sat down with him and asked Miśra, "What would you like to hear?"

60 He said, "Please tell me, in order, all that you spoke of in Vidyānagara.[17]

61 You are the instructor not only of others but of the Lord Himself! I am a poor mendicant brāhmaṇa, and you are my sustainer.

62 I do not know how to ask anything, good or bad. Seeing how wretched I am, be merciful and tell me of your own accord."

63 Then Rāmānanda began to speak of Kṛṣṇa in due order, and in his words the nectar-ocean of rasa surged up.

64 He himself raised the questions and then gave the conclusive answers (*siddhānta*). The third watch (*prahara*) of the day came, and still the talk did not end.

65 Speaker and listener, one speaking and the other hearing, were both absorbed in prema. They had no awareness of themselves — how could they know the day had ended?

66 When the servant said, “The day is over,” Rāya brought his talk of Kṛṣṇa to a close.

67 With great respect he bade Miśra farewell, and Miśra, crying, “My life is fulfilled!” began to dance.

68 Miśra went home, bathed and took his meal, and in the evening he came to see the Lord.

69 With a joyful heart he bowed at the Lord’s feet, and the Lord asked, “Did you hear about Kṛṣṇa?”

70 Miśra said, “O Lord, You have fulfilled my life! You have plunged me into the nectar-ocean of talks about Kṛṣṇa.

71 The words of Rāmānanda Rāya cannot be retold. Rāya is not a mere human being; he is made of the rasa of devotion to Kṛṣṇa.[18]

72 Rāya told me one thing more: ‘Do not think of me as the speaker of these talks about Kṛṣṇa.

73 Gauracandra Himself speaks these words through my mouth. As He makes me speak, so I speak, like a *vīṇā*.

74 Through my mouth He makes these words known. Who in this world will understand this pastime of His?'

75 All that I heard — that Kṛṣṇa is the ocean of rasa — lies beyond the reach even of Brahmā and the other gods.

76 You have made me drink such rasa; birth after birth I have sold myself at Your feet."

77 The Lord said, "Rāmānanda is a mine of humility. He attributes his own words to another.

78 This is the natural disposition of great souls: they never speak of their own qualities."

79 Thus I have told a little of Rāmānanda Rāya's qualities and of how he instructed Pradyumna Miśra.

80 Though a householder, Rāya is not under the control of the six enemies (*ṣaḍ-varga*); though seemingly a worldly man (*viṣayī*), he instructs sannyāsīs.[19]

81 To reveal all these qualities of his, the Lord sent Miśra there to hear.

82 The Lord knows well how to reveal the qualities of His devotees; revealing them in various ways, He considers it His own gain.

83 Hear, O devotees, of yet another trait of Gaura: He makes His hidden, majestic nature manifest.

84 To destroy the pride of the sannyāsīs and paṇḍitas, He reveals dharma through a lowly śūdra.[20]

85 He speaks of bhakti, prema and the truth (*tattva*), making Rāya the speaker, while He Himself, together with Pradyumna Miśra, becomes the listener.[21]

86 Through Haridāsa He revealed the glory of the holy name; through Sanātana, the conclusions of bhakti in all their splendour.[22]

87 Through Śrī Rūpa He revealed Vraja's pastimes of rasa and prema. Who can describe the profound play of Caitanya?[23]

88 These pastimes of Śrī Caitanya are an ocean of nectar, a single drop of which can flood the world.

89 Drink the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* constantly, for from it come the bliss of prema and knowledge of the truth of bhakti.

90 In this way Mahāprabhu, together with His devotees, enjoyed His pastimes in Nīlācala, preaching bhakti.

91 A brāhmaṇa from Bengal composed a drama on the Lord's life and brought it with him to recite.[24]

92 He was acquainted with Bhagavān Ācārya; having met him, he took lodging in his house.

93 First he recited the drama to him, and many Vaiṣṇavas heard it along with him.

94 Everyone praised the drama as “most excellent”, and all wished to have Mahāprabhu hear it.

95 Whatever song, verse, book or poem anyone composed and brought would first be recited before Svarūpa.

96 If it passed Svarūpa’s scrutiny and won his approval, only then would it be recited before Mahāprabhu.[25]

97 If there was *rasābhāsa*, a mere semblance of rasa, or anything opposed to *siddhānta*, the Lord could not bear it, and anger arose in His mind.[26]

98 Therefore the Lord would hear nothing that Svarūpa had not examined first; He had made this a fixed rule of propriety.

99 Bhagavān Ācārya made a request to Svarūpa: “A poet has composed an excellent drama about the Lord.[27]

100 Hear it first yourself, and if you approve of it, I shall then have Mahāprabhu hear it.”

101 Svarūpa said, “You are a simple ‘cowherd’ (*gopa*), and most generous: you wish to hear any writing whatever.[28]

102 In the words of just any poet there is *rasābhāsa*, and hearing what is opposed to *siddhānta* brings no joy.[29]

103 One who cannot discriminate between rasa and *rasābhāsa* never reaches the far shore of the ocean of *bhakti-siddhānta*.

104–105 A worthless poet who knows neither grammar nor rhetoric, and has no knowledge of the ornaments of drama, does not know how to de-

scribe Kṛṣṇa's pastimes; and these pastimes of Caitanya are especially hard to enter!

106 Only one for whom the lotus feet of Gaura are the very wealth of life can describe the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa and the pastimes of Gaura.

107 To hear the poetry of a mundane poet (*grāmya-kavi*) is painful; to hear the words of one who is expert and intimate (*vidagdha ātmīya*) is a joy.[30]

108 Take the two dramas Rūpa has composed: merely hearing their prologues makes one's joy grow."

109 Bhagavān Ācārya said, "Just hear it once. When you have heard it, you will be able to judge whether it is good or bad."

110 For two or three days the Ācārya pressed him, and at his insistence Svarūpa agreed to hear it.

111 Svarūpa Gosāñi sat down with everyone to listen, and the poet recited the *nāndī* verse, the opening benediction.

112 "He of golden lustre has here found His self in the One named Śrī Jagannātha, whose eyes are like blossoming lotuses, and has appeared, bringing consciousness to the whole of inert nature. May that Kṛṣṇa Caitanya-deva grant you good fortune."[31]

113 Hearing the verse, everyone praised the poet, but Svarūpa said, "Explain this verse."

114 The poet said, "Jagannātha is the beautiful body, and Caitanya Gosāñi, perfectly steady (*mahā-dhīra*), is the one embodied in it (*śarīrī*).[32]

115 To bestow consciousness on the inert world, as is His nature, Mahāprabhu has appeared in Nīlācala."

116 Hearing this, everyone was delighted, but Svarūpa, deeply pained, spoke angry words:[33]

117 "O fool, you have brought about your own utter ruin! You have no faith in either of the two Lords![34]

118 Lord Jagannātha is full of bliss, a form of pure spirit, yet you have made Him out to be an inert, perishable, material body![35]

119 Caitanya, full in all six opulences, is Svayam Bhagavān, the Supreme Lord Himself, yet you have made Him out to be a tiny jīva, like a spark![36]

120 For this offence against both you will meet a dire fate! When one ignorant of the truth describes the truth, this is the end he comes to!

121 You have made yet another great blunder (*pramāda*): by distinguishing between body and embodied in the Lord, you have committed an offence!

122 In the Lord there is never any difference between body and embodied. His own form (*svarūpa*) and His body are both spirit and bliss; there is no difference between them.

123 "This division of body and embodied never exists in the Lord." (Kūrma Purāṇa)[37]

124 "O Supreme Lord, I see nothing higher than this form of Yours, which is pure bliss, free of all difference, its radiance unobscured. You are the one creator of the universe, yet You are distinct from it, O Self, and You are the

source of the elements and the senses. I have taken shelter of that form of Yours." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.9.3)[38]

125 "O good of all the worlds, for our good You have shown this very form to us, Your worshippers, in meditation. We bow down to You, Bhagavān, whom those bound for hell, attached to false arguments, do not honour." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.9.4)[39]

126 Where is Kṛṣṇa, full of bliss and opulence, the Great Lord (*Maheśvara*)? And where is the tiny, miserable jīva, a servant of māyā?

127 "The Lord, embraced by the hlādinī and saṁvit potencies, is eternal being, consciousness and bliss; the jīva, covered by its own ignorance, is a mine of countless miseries." (words of Viṣṇusvāmī quoted by Śrīdhara Svāmī in his commentary on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.7.5–6)[40]

128 Hearing this, the whole assembly was struck with wonder: "The Gosāñi speaks the truth! The poet has insulted both."

129 The poet was filled with shame, fear and amazement; like a heron among swans, he could say nothing.

130 Seeing his distress, the most merciful Svarūpa instructed him in a way that would bring him true good:

131 "Go and study the *Bhāgavata* under a Vaiṣṇava, and take exclusive shelter at the feet of Caitanya.[41]

132 Always keep the company of Caitanya's devotees; then you will come to know the waves of the ocean of *siddhānta*.

133 Then your learning will bear fruit, and you will describe Kṛṣṇa's true nature and pastimes purely, without fault.

134 You composed this verse with great satisfaction, but the meaning you had in mind lays fault on both Lords.

135 You spoke at random, not knowing the proper way; yet with those very words Sarasvatī has offered praise.[42]

136 When Indra, the demons and others rebuke Kṛṣṇa, Sarasvatī offers praise with those very words.

137 "Taking shelter of Kṛṣṇa — a talkative, childish, stubborn, ignorant mortal who thinks Himself learned — these cowherds have offended me." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.25.5)[43]

138 Indra, maddened by the intoxication of his opulence, was like a drunkard: his intelligence was lost, and he had no self-control at all.

139 Indra says, "I have reviled Kṛṣṇa," yet from his very mouth Sarasvatī offers praise.

140 '*Vācāla*' (talkative) means the glorious One who set the Vedas in motion; and '*bāliśa*' (childish) means that, great as He is, He is like a child, free of pride.

141 Because there is no one for Him to honour, He bows to none: this is what the word '*stabdha*' (stubborn) says. And He beyond whom there is no other knower is '*ajña*' (ignorant) — there is nothing for Him to learn.

142 The one honoured by the learned is '*paṇḍita-mānī*'; yet out of affection for His devotees He regards Himself as a human being, a 'mortal'.

143 Jarāsandha said, “Kṛṣṇa is the lowest of men! I will not fight with You — go away, slayer of Your kinsmen!”

144 He in comparison with whom all other persons are lower is ‘*puruṣādhama*’ — that is Sarasvatī’s meaning.

145 Because it binds everyone, ignorance (*avidyā*) is the ‘*bandhu*’; so the word ‘*bandhu-han*’ means the destroyer of ignorance.

146 In the same way Śiśupāla reviled Kṛṣṇa, and with those very words Sarasvatī offered praise.

147 So too with this verse: in your meaning it speaks blame. Now hear Sarasvatī’s meaning, in which praise shines forth.

148 Jagannātha is Kṛṣṇa’s very self (*ātma-svarūpa*), but here He is the Dāru-brahma, in an immobile form.[44]

149 Caitanya is one with Him in self and form: Kṛṣṇa, the one truth, has appeared in two forms.[45]

150 Uniting in that will (*icchā-śakti*) whose aim is to deliver souls from *saṁsāra*, They attain such oneness.

151 To deliver all the people of the world, He descended in the moving form of Gaura.

152 By seeing Jagannātha one is freed from *saṁsāra*, but not all the people of every land can come to Him.

153 So Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Prabhu, going from land to land as the moving Brahman (*jaṅgama-brahma*), delivered everyone.

154 This is the explanation I have given of Sarasvatī's meaning. It is your good fortune, too, that you described Them in this way.

155 One may utter Kṛṣṇa's name only to abuse Him, yet that very name becomes the cause of his liberation."[46]

156 Then the poet fell at everyone's feet and, holding straw between his teeth, took shelter of them all.

157 All the devotees then accepted him and, speaking of his good qualities, introduced him to Mahāprabhu.[47]

158 The poet gave up everything and remained in Nīlācala. Who can describe the mercy of Gaura's devotees?[48]

159 Thus I have told the account of Pradyumna Miśra, who by the Lord's order heard talks about Kṛṣṇa.

160 Within it I have spoken of the glory of Rāmānanda, the full extent of which the Lord Himself described with His own holy lips.

161 In passing I have also related the story of the poet's drama: ignorant though he was, by faith he attained the Lord's feet.[49]

162 The pastimes of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya are the essence of nectar: from the stream of a single pastime flow hundreds upon hundreds of currents.

163 Whoever reads or hears this pastime with faith comes to know the pastimes of Gaura, bhakti, the devotees and the truth of rasa.

164 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. *Anubhāṣya*: *vaiguṇya* — the ripening of the fruits of karma; *paiśunya* — malice. Edition heading: for the jīva bereft of consciousness, stricken with the disease of worldly existence and fallen into the ocean of saṁsāra, the only good lies in taking shelter of Caitanya's feet. ↩
2. Edition heading: the Lord pretends not to know and sends Miśra, born in a family of brāhmaṇas, to Rāmānanda as an eager disciple — to Rāmānanda, who was not a brāhmaṇa by birth, yet is the guru of all four varṇas and āśramas. ↩
3. *Anubhāṣya*: the dharma of varṇa and āśrama; if it does not awaken attraction (*rati*) to the narrations about the Lord, it is wholly fruitless labour. ↩
4. The *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* calls them young *devadāsīs* (now called *māhārīs*), and the *Anubhāṣya* (on 25) "two devadāsīs" — maidservants of the Deity who dance before Śrī Jagannātha. ↩
5. *Anubhāṣya*: his own drama — the *Jagannātha-vallabha*, which Rāmānanda Rāya wrote in Sanskrit. ↩
6. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the two girls were to play the principal gopīs in the drama, so he regarded them as the ones to be served and took the mood of a maidservant following them; Rāmānanda knew himself to be a maidservant of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī. ↩
7. Edition heading: to stage his drama *Jagannātha-vallabha* before Śrī Jagannātha, Rāya teaches acting in the Jagannātha-vallabha garden. ↩
8. Edition heading: after feeding the two devadāsīs, Rāya sends them home in secret — for the good of ignorant critics who judge only by what the senses show. ↩
9. Edition heading: Bhagavān, the ideal teacher of humility, humbly extols His devotee's love for Kṛṣṇa as greater than His own. ↩
10. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads "তাহাদের সব সেবা", "every service for them" (*Anubhāṣya*: all kinds of service; cf. 39). ↩
11. *Anubhāṣya*: the thirty-three kinds of *bhāva* needed to enact the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa. ↩
12. The second line is the same as Madhya 13.67; translation as there. ↩
13. *Anubhāṣya*: this is said of one who, with faith and a transcendental heart, hears and describes Kṛṣṇa's pastimes: the three guṇas cannot overcome him. Let no one think, like the prākṛta-sahajiyās, that without knowledge of sambandha, giving up sādhana-bhakti and taking Kṛṣṇa's pastimes as a model of worldly enjoyment, one's lust will vanish by merely hearing; by the word "faith" (*viśvāsa*) Mahāprabhu rejects that view (cf. Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.33.30). ↩

14. *Anubhāṣya*: *pratilabhya* — “having attained”: devotion comes first, and lust is driven out; *anuśṛṇuyāt* — he hears constantly from the lips of the guru, free from worldly obstacles; *varṇayet* — he sings of it step by step, in the way of Śrī Rūpa’s followers; *dhīraḥ* — one who has conquered the six urges. ↩
15. *Anubhāṣya*: one who hears and chants Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes and, following the mood of Śrī Rūpa, serves Kṛṣṇa in the mind at every moment, absorbed in pure rāga, gains a matchless fruit that no worldly language can describe. ↩
16. *Anubhāṣya*: he is an eternally perfect associate; or else his body is almost perfect — though seen by people’s eyes, it is the abode of feelings devoted to the service of Kṛṣṇa, until by Kṛṣṇa’s will he attains *vastu-siddhi*. ↩
17. Edition heading: Miśra asks him to speak again of Kṛṣṇa — of sambandha, abhidheya and prayojana — as Rāya once spoke to the Lord (Madhya 8). ↩
18. Edition heading: it is forbidden to regard as a mortal the guru who sings of Kṛṣṇa. ↩
19. *Anubhāṣya*: worldly people see in Rāmānanda a householder and a *viṣayī*, absorbed in worldly objects, but his mind of pure goodness always worships a single object — the pastimes of Śrī Kṛṣṇa; he is thus a “kṛṣṇa-viṣayī”, able to turn even sannyāsīs to Kṛṣṇa. ↩
20. Edition heading: worldly varṇāśrama, learning and the like are no sign of one able to speak of true dharma. *Anubhāṣya*: the worldly eye knows Rāmānanda Rāya as a śūdra, the lowest of the varṇas, and as a householder, the lowest of the āśramas; through him the Lord instructed Pradyumna Miśra, a brāhmaṇa by birth, and He Himself, having accepted sannyāsa, accepted the dharma Rāmānanda preached. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: whoever, knowing the difference between mundane and transcendental truth, has learned transcendental devotion to Kṛṣṇa is the teacher of all souls, whatever his birth and āśrama. ↩
21. Edition heading: the Lord Himself in the dress of a sannyāsī and Miśra, a brāhmaṇa by birth, both become disciples eager to hear and choose as their guru Śrī Rāya — dressed as a householder, born outside the brāhmaṇa families, a singer of Kṛṣṇa — and so teach the world. ↩
22. Edition heading: to Ṭhākura Haridāsa, born among the yavanas, the Lord gives the rank of guru of the world and ācārya of the holy name; Śrī Sanātana, though he had lived among mlecchas, is the ācārya of the conclusions of devotion to Kṛṣṇa, that is, of knowledge of *sambandha*. ↩
23. Edition heading: Śrī Rūpa is the ācārya of the rasa of loving devotion of Vraja, that is, of *abhidheya*. ↩

24. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads “লঞা আইলা শুনাইতে”, without “প্রভুকে” (“to the Lord”). Edition heading: the story of a worldly poet from East Bengal in the guise of a brāhmaṇa. ↩
25. Edition heading (95–96): the rule — Svarūpa Dāmodara examines everything first; only a work that has passed his test receives the Lord’s grace. ↩
26. *Anubhāṣya*: *rasābhāsa* is what seems to be rasa but is incomplete in its marks; Śrī Viśvanātha Cakravartī says that it arises when two rasas hostile to each other are joined; *siddhānta-virodha* is contradiction of the conclusions of the path of bhakti. Edition heading: the one cause of the magnanimous Lord’s anger is contradiction of the word of bhakti-siddhānta. ↩
27. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads “এক কবি”, “a poet” (the text Vṛndāvana Candra dāsa followed has “এক বিপ্র”, “a brāhmaṇa”). Edition heading: Bhagavān Ācārya’s request to Svarūpa; praise of the worldly poet’s work. ↩
28. Edition heading: Svarūpa, best of the knowers of Kṛṣṇa-tattva, who knows the heart, rebukes Bhagavān Ācārya. ↩
29. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *yadvā tadvā kavi* — just any poet, that is, those who compose verse without properly knowing either rasa-tattva or the Vaiṣṇava *siddhānta*. ↩
30. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *grāmya-kavi* — poets who write verse about worldly men and women; *vidagdha ātmīya-vākya* — the work of one close at heart, skilled in the knowledge of tattva and belonging to the community of pure devotees. Edition heading: a mundane poet, who does not seek Kṛṣṇa’s happiness, is an outsider (*bahiraṅga*); a transcendental poet, devoted to Kṛṣṇa’s happiness, is one’s own (*antaraṅga*). ↩
31. Edition heading: the *nāndī* verse, composed by the Bengali brāhmaṇa. The words *ātmani ātmatāṁ prapannaḥ* bear both the poet’s sense (114) and Sarasvatī’s (148–149). *Anubhāṣya*: in the poet’s sense, Gaura entered Jagannātha’s body as its owner, and the “inert nature” is the Deity of Jagannātha, seen as wood; in Sarasvatī’s sense, Śrī Kṛṣṇa in Gaura’s golden form attained complete non-difference from Śrī Jagannātha — the Lord of māyā, the Dāru-brahma, the Supreme Self full in six opulences. ↩
32. Edition heading: the foolish poet’s error — Māyāvāda, opposed to the conclusions of pure bhakti. *Anubhāṣya*: *śarīrī* — he whose body it is, the embodied one (*dehī*). ↩
33. Edition heading: all rejoiced, but Śrī Svarūpa, the Vaiṣṇava ācārya and teacher of the world, grows angry and so shows his mercy: with the sword of scriptural siddhānta he cuts down the false doctrine. ↩

34. Edition heading: the cause of his anger: (1) to regard Viṣṇu as a jīva leads to hell. ↩
35. *Anubhāṣya*: to see in the Deity of Jagannātha only a wooden image, perishable and material, is an offence; the Deity is non-different from Śrī Kṛṣṇa, and the devotee, with eyes of bhakti, sees Him directly as the full form of eternity, knowledge and bliss. ↩
36. *Anubhāṣya*: by the śruti "As sparks fly from a fire…" the jīva is like a spark of the fire that is the great Viṣṇu, a particle of spirit; but Śrī Caitanya-deva, the Lord of māyā, taking a human form does not make Him a tiny jīva subject to matter. ↩
37. Edition heading: words of the *Kūrma Purāṇa* quoted in the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (Pūrva-khaṇḍa, 128). ↩
38. = Madhya 25.36; translation as there. ↩
39. = Madhya 25.37; translation as there. *Anubhāṣya* (on Madhya 25.37): *asat-prasaṅgaiḥ* — those attached to false arguments, absorbed in speculation on the impersonal Brahman contrary to the path of the śrutis. ↩
40. = Madhya 18.114; translation as there. Edition heading: the *Sarvajña-sūkta* as quoted in the *Bhagavat-sandarbha*, or the words of Śrī Viṣṇusvāmī quoted by Śrīdhara Svāmī in his commentary on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.7.6. ↩
41. *Anubhāṣya*: from a Māyāvādī, from a grammarian clever with words but without bhakti, or from a pleasure-seeker greedy for money, the *Bhāgavata* will not bring love for Kṛṣṇa — only the taste for the mundane will grow; it must be studied only with a Vaiṣṇava paramahaṁsa who has renounced the world, and its meaning, revealed by Śrī Caitanya, is attained by taking exclusive shelter at His feet. ↩
42. Edition heading: even through the words of a fool or an enemy reviling Kṛṣṇa, pure Sarasvatī — Kṛṣṇa's maidservant, the very word of bhakti-siddhānta — serves Gaura-Kṛṣṇa. *Anubhāṣya*: out of ignorance the poet did not see the difference between Māyāvāda and the path of bhakti, and expressed himself at random; but with those very ill-chosen words Sarasvatī glorified her worshipful Gaura-Kṛṣṇa. ↩
43. *Anubhāṣya*: in Indra's sense — wordy, a child or a fool, ill-mannered, blind to consequences, a mortal who thinks himself learned; in Sarasvatī's sense (140–142) — the source of the Vedas, free of pride, bowing to none, all-knowing, honoured by the learned, appearing as a man out of love for His devotees. ↩
44. *Dāru-brahma* — the Brahman manifest in a form of sacred wood (*dāru*); to see in the Deity only a wooden image is an offence (*Anubhāṣya*, see 118). Edition heading (147–148): Svarūpa explains the worldly poet's words as praise of

Kṛṣṇa and establishes the non-difference of the Dāru-brahma, Jagannātha, from the moving Brahman (*jaṅgama-brahma*), Gaurahari. ↩

45. Edition heading: to deliver the world, the one Deity is manifest in two forms by the power of His will (*icchā-śakti*). ↩
46. Edition heading: even when Kṛṣṇa is reviled, the name uttered as *stobha* — *nāmābhāsa* — grants liberation. *Stobha* is a kind of *nāmābhāsa*: the name uttered not for its own sake. ↩
47. Edition heading: first the devotees' mercy, and through it the mercy of Mahāprabhu. ↩
48. Edition heading: the poet accepts the dharma of sannyāsa and lives in Purī. ↩
49. Edition heading: through faith in the Vaiṣṇavas even an ignorant poet obtains the Lord's mercy. ↩